

**1913**

## The first crossword

The world's first modern crossword, by British-American journalist Arthur Wynne, was published in the *New York World* newspaper – although the idea can be traced back to ancient Rome.

## Born this day

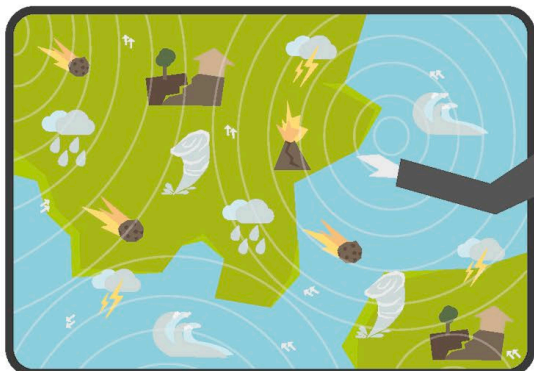
**1914 Frank Fenner**, Australian scientist. He helped to eradicate smallpox and to control Australia's rabbit plagues.

**1948 Samuel L Jackson**, Black American actor and producer. His films have made more than US \$27 billion worldwide.

**2012**

## Maya doomsday

The end of a cycle of the Maya calendar led to predictions that the world would end on this date, although scholars have never found evidence that the ancient Mayas actually believed this.



**1968**

## Lift-off!

*Apollo 8* was launched from the Kennedy Space Centre in Florida, USA. It was the first crewed spacecraft to leave Earth's orbit and reach another celestial object, the Moon, which it orbited 10 times.



## Also on this day

**1848 Ellen and William Craft** escaped enslavement by daringly disguising themselves as a white man travelling with his servant.

**1988 A bomb exploded on board Pan Am Flight 103** over Lockerbie, Scotland, killing 270 people – the UK's deadliest air disaster.

**2020 Saturn and Jupiter appeared in a "great conjunction"**, the closest they had been when viewed from Earth since 1623.

